

HYBRID ATHLETE

2026 TRAINING PROGRAM

Nick Bare Method · Triathlon · Spartan Trifecta · DEKA

Strength · Endurance · Obstacle Racing · Speed

DAY	AM SESSION	PM SESSION	FOCUS
Monday	Full Body Strength	Run 30-45 min	Strength + Speed
Tuesday	Swim 30-45 min	Rest / Mobility	Technique + Recovery
Wednesday	Full Body Strength	Bike / Run 45-60 min	Strength + Aerobic
Thursday	Swim 30-45 min (AM)	Spin Class 5:30 PM	Endurance + Bike Power
Friday	Full Body Strength	Short Bike or Rest	Strength + Flush
Saturday	LONG EFFORT	Swim / Brick / Race Sim	Aerobic Capacity
Sunday	Active Recovery Zone 2	Mobility & Foam Roll	Recovery

TARGET RACES	TRIATHLON	SPARTAN TRIFECTA	DEKA
Events	Sprint or Olympic Swim · Bike · Run	Sprint + Super + Beast Obstacle Course Racing	10 Zones · Rower Sled · Sandbag · SkiErg

NICK BARE HYBRID ATHLETE PHILOSOPHY

>> NEVER SACRIFICE ONE FOR THE OTHER	Build strength AND endurance simultaneously. Never compromise your lifts or your miles.
>> PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD - BOTH DOMAINS	Add weight/ reps in the gym every 2 weeks. Increase run/bike/swim volume by max 10% per week.
>> TRAIN YOUR WEAKNESS	Running feels easy? Push harder there. Squats plateau? Add volume. Always attack the weaker pillar.
>> FUELING IS NON-NEGOTIABLE	Protein 0.8-1g per lb bodyweight. Carbs before and after every session. You cannot out-train poor nutrition.
>> CONSISTENCY > PERFECTION	Traveling? Sub in the bodyweight circuit. A modified session always beats zero sessions.
>> TWO-A-DAYS ARE A TOOL, NOT PUNISHMENT	AM strength + PM cardio. Separate by 6+ hours. Keep PM sessions aerobic (Zone 2-3).

RPE GUIDE & HEART RATE ZONES

RPE	FEEL	HR ZONE	USE FOR	DESCRIPTION
1-3	Very Easy	Zone 1	Warm-up/Cool-down	Could hold a full conversation
4-5	Moderate	Zone 2	Long aerobic work	Nasal breathing, easy talking
6-7	Comfortably Hard	Zone 3	Tempo/bike intervals	Short sentences only
8	Hard	Zone 4	Threshold intervals	1-2 words, breathing heavy
9	Very Hard	Zone 5	VO2max efforts	Barely speaking
10	Max Effort	Zone 5+	Sprints, DEKA finish	Cannot speak

FULL BODY STRENGTH SESSIONS (Mon / Wed / Fri - AM) | 40 MINUTES

Optimized for 40 min by using **supersets** (2 exercises back-to-back with minimal rest) and trimming accessory work. Each session alternates between A, B, and C to hit all patterns across the week. **Rest 45-60s between supersets, 20-30s within a superset.** Load/reps evolve by phase — see progressive loading table.

WARM-UP 5 min

SUPERSET A 10 min

SUPERSET B 10 min

ARMS 5 min

POWER / OCF 7 min

COOL-DOWN 3 min

MON — SESSION A

Focus: Lower Push + Upper Pull + Arms

WARM-UP 5 min 3 min jump rope / row erg + Band pull-aparts 1x15 + Goblet squat 1x10

SUPERSET A (4 rounds — 10 min)			SUPERSET B (3 rounds — 10 min)		
EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE
A1 Back Squat	See phase table	Brace core, break parallel — full depth	B1 Romanian Deadlift	3x8	Hinge at hips, soft knees, bar close to legs
A2 Weighted Pull-Up	See phase table	Dead hang start, chin clears bar	B2 Dumbbell Row	3x10 ea	Elbow drives back, brace core, no twist

ARMS SUPERSET (3 rounds — 5 min)

EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	COACHING CUE
C1 Barbell / EZ Bar Curl	3x10	Bicep mass + peak	Full ROM — dead hang at bottom, squeeze at top
C2 Skull Crushers (EZ bar)	3x10	Tricep mass + length	Lower bar to forehead slowly, extend fully

POWER / OCF FINISHER (pick 1 — 7 min)

EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	CUE
Box Jumps	4x5	Explosive power	Soft landing, reset fully each rep
Farmers Carry	4x35m	Grip + DEKA/OCF	Shoulders packed, chest tall
KB Swings	3x15	Hip power + cardio	Hinge hard, snap hips

COOL-DOWN 5 min Hip flexor stretch 45s ea + Pigeon pose 45s ea + Lat hang 30s

WED — SESSION B

Focus: Upper Push + Lower Pull + Arms

WARM-UP 5 min 3 min row erg / jump rope + Dead bug 1x8 ea + Band pull-aparts 1x15

SUPERSET A (4 rounds — 10 min)			SUPERSET B (3 rounds — 10 min)		
EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE
A1 Barbell Bench Press	See phase table	Elbows 45deg, arch neutral, full ROM	B1 Bulgarian Split Squat	3x8 ea	Front foot forward, torso upright, no knee cave
A2 Barbell Hip Thrust	3x10	Drive through heel, squeeze hard at top	B2 Overhead Press	3x8	Core tight, ribs down, press in a straight line

ARMS SUPERSET (3 rounds — 5 min)

EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	COACHING CUE
C1 Incline DB Curl	3x10	Bicep stretch + growth	Lean back on incline bench — full stretch at bottom
C2 Tricep Overhead Extension (DB)	3x10	Tricep long head mass	Both hands on one DB — full stretch overhead

POWER / OCF FINISHER (pick 1 — 7 min)

EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	CUE
Sandbag Carry (45lb M / 35lb W)	4x40m	Spartan race weight	Hug to chest, head up, stable core
Sled Push (DEKA Zone 4: ~90lb M / ~45lb W)	3x20m	DEKA sled zone	Low hips, drive from glutes, stay low
Towel Pull-Up	3x5	Spartan grip	Full hang, supinated grip on towel

COOL-DOWN 5 min Pigeon pose 45s ea + Shoulder cross-body stretch 30s ea + Breathing 2 min

FRI — SESSION C

Focus: Full Body Power + Arms + Race-Specific

WARM-UP 5 min 3 min jump rope + Goblet squat 1x10 + Band pull-aparts 1x15

SUPERSET A (4 rounds — 10 min)			SUPERSET B (3 rounds — 10 min)		
EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE	EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	CUE
A1 Back Squat	See phase table — same as Mon	Focus: speed out of the hole	B1 Bench Press	See phase table — same as Wed	Try 1-2 extra reps vs Wed if possible
A2 Weighted Pull-Up	See phase table — same as Mon	Increase load vs Mon if possible	B2 Single-Leg RDL	3x8 ea	Slow and controlled, hinge at hip

ARMS SUPERSET (3 rounds — 5 min)			
EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	COACHING CUE
C1 Hammer Curl (DBs)	3x12	Brachialis + bicep thickness	Neutral grip, controlled tempo — no swinging
C2 Close-Grip Push-Up / Dips	3x12	Tricep strength + size	Elbows tight to body, full lockout at top
POWER / OCF FINISHER (pick 1 — 7 min)			
EXERCISE	SETS x REPS	PURPOSE	CUE
Power Clean (light)	3x4	Full-body power	Smooth pull, catch in partial squat
Rope Climb / Towel Pull	3x3-5	Spartan rope grip	Use feet on rope, grip strength focus
Plank + Core Circuit	3x40s	Core stability	Hollow body — rotate: plank / side plank / dead bug
COOL-DOWN 5 min	Hip flexor stretch 45s ea + Lat hang 30s + Foam roll quads + glutes 2 min		

PROGRESSIVE LOADING - MAIN LIFTS BY PHASE

PHASE	WEEKS	BACK SQUAT	BENCH PRESS	WEIGHTED PULL-UP	GOAL
BASE	1-4	4x8 @70% 1RM	4x8 @70% 1RM	4x6 (add 5lb/wk)	Build foundation, perfect form
BUILD	5-8	4x6 @78% 1RM	4x6 @78% 1RM	4x5 (heavier)	Increase load, maintain volume
PEAK	9-11	5x3 @85-90% 1RM	5x3 @85-90%	5x3 (weighted)	Max strength expression
TAPER	12	3x5 @70% 1RM	3x5 @70% 1RM	3x5 (bodyweight)	Freshen up for race week

CARDIO & ENDURANCE SESSIONS

SLOT	SESSION TYPE	DETAILS	RPE	PURPOSE
Mon PM	Run - Speed/Tempo	Ph1: 25-30 min easy @Zone 2 Ph2: 6-8x400m @RPE 8 Ph3: Tempo 25-30 min @RPE 7	5-9	Run fitness / Race pace
Tue AM	Swim	Ph1: 20-25 min drills + easy laps Ph2: 400m warm-up + 4x100m sets Ph3: Race-pace 600m+ sets	3-7	Triathlon swim base
Wed PM	Bike / Run (Brick)	Ph1: 30-40 min easy bike OR run Ph2: 45 min bike + 10 min run Ph3: 60 min bike + 20 min run	4-7	Brick training / Base
Thu AM	Swim + OCF Drills	20-30 min swim + 15 min obstacle skills (grip hangs, sandbag carry, crawl drills)	4-6	Swim endurance + OCF
Thu PM	Spin Class 5:30 PM	45 min structured spin — instructor-led intervals Zone 3-4 efforts: standing climbs, sprints, tempo Skip on race/taper weeks — easy 30 min or rest	5-8	Bike power + tri base
Fri PM	Short Bike or Rest	20-30 min easy bike OR full rest (rest wins on heavy lift weeks)	3-4	Active flush after lift
Saturday	LONG EFFORT (rotate)	Wk 1,5,9: Long Run (60-120 min) Wk 2,6,10: Long Bike (90-150 min) Wk 3,7,11: Brick (Bike+Run) Wk 4,8: Race Simulation / Test	5-7	Triathlon / Endurance base
Sunday	Active Recovery	30-45 min walk, light swim, yoga or Zone 1 easy bike	1-3	Recovery & mobility

TRAVEL & BODYWEIGHT ALTERNATIVES

Keep a resistance band loop set in your bag at all times. A 30-min hotel room session beats zero every time.

TRAVEL STRENGTH SESSION (30-40 min, no gym needed)

GYM LIFT	BODYWEIGHT SUB	RESISTANCE BAND SUB	NOTES
Back Squat	Jump Squat 4x15 OR Pistol Squat 3x8 ea	Band Squat 4x20 (band under feet, over shoulders)	Add 3-sec eccentric to increase difficulty
Romanian Deadlift	Single-Leg RDL (BW) 3x12 ea OR Nordic Hamstring Curl	Band Good Morning 3x15 Band Pull-Through 3x15	Use table edge for Nordic curls
Bench Press	Push-Up Variations 4x20 (wide, narrow, archer, pike)	Band Press 3x20 (anchor band behind, press forward)	Elevate feet for upper chest
Pull-Up / Row	Table/Chair Row 3x15 Doorway Row if available	Band Pull-Apart 3x20 Band Lat Pulldown 3x15	Loop band over door for pulldowns
Overhead Press	Pike Push-Up 3x12 Handstand Push-Up (wall)	Band OHP 3x15 (stand on band, press up)	Face wall for assisted HS OHP
Power Finisher	Burpee Box Jump (chair) 4x8 Mountain Climbers 3x30s	Band Squat Jump 3x12 Resistance Sprint (band at waist)	30s rest only to maintain HR
Farmers Carry	Suitcase Carry with bags 3x40m Single-arm overhead carry	Band Suitcase Walk 3x30m (band under foot, hold handle)	Use filled water bottles or luggage

TRAVEL QUICK CIRCUIT (20 min, hotel room, zero equipment)

#	EXERCISE	WORK	REST	TARGET
1	Jump Squat	40 sec	20 sec	Legs / Power
2	Push-Up	40 sec	20 sec	Chest / Tricep
3	Reverse Lunge	40 sec ea	20 sec	Legs / Glute
4	Renegade Row (bag)	40 sec	20 sec	Back / Core
5	Burpee	40 sec	20 sec	Full Body / Cardio
6	Plank to Push-Up	40 sec	20 sec	Core / Shoulder
7	Glute Bridge Pulse	40 sec	20 sec	Glute / Hamstring
8	Mountain Climbers	40 sec	20 sec	Core / Cardio
Rest 2 min, then repeat 2-3 rounds total				

SWIM SPEED DRILLS (Tue AM + Thu AM — Triathlon Preparation)

Your current swim pace: **2:42/100m**. Target race pace: **2:25/100m** for Olympic tri. These drills target the 4 biggest speed levers: catch mechanics, body rotation, kick efficiency, and pacing. Use 2 drills per session as your warm-up, then apply the technique during your main set.

CURRENT 2:42/100m	BLOCK 2 TARGET 2:35/100m	BLOCK 3 TARGET 2:28/100m	RACE GOAL 2:25/100m
-------------------	--------------------------	--------------------------	---------------------

CATCH & PULL — The #1 speed lever

Catch-Up Drill ■ youtube.be/HJRzUQMhJMQ	HOW: One arm stays fully extended until the recovering arm touches it before pulling.	WHY: Slows your stroke so you can feel a proper high-elbow catch. Most swimmers lose speed by pulling with a dropped elbow — this fixes it.	4x50 @1:30 — every Tue warm-up, Wks 1-12
Fingertip Drag ■ youtube.be/V_m952iKnCU	HOW: During the recovery phase, drag your fingertips lightly along the water surface from hip to extension.	WHY: Forces a high elbow recovery, preventing a wide arm swing that kills rotation and wastes energy.	4x50 @1:30 — alternate with Catch-Up, Wks 1-10
Fist Drill ■ youtube.be/Hv14ZM_Rv_8	HOW: Swim with hands in a closed fist for 50m, then open hands for 50m. Feel the difference.	WHY: Forces your forearm to engage as a paddle — massively increases the surface area of your pull.	4x(50 fist + 50 open) — Wks 5+ main warm-up

BODY ROTATION — Free speed with no extra effort

Side Kick Drill ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=side+kick+drill+6+kick+switch+freestyle+triathlon	HOW: Kick on your side with bottom arm extended, top arm at hip. Hold for 6 kicks, then take 3 strokes and switch sides.	WHY: Teaches you to rotate your hips fully with each stroke — proper rotation adds 5-10% more power to your pull without extra effort.	6x50 @1:30 — Thu warm-up, Wks 3-16
---	---	---	---

3-3-3 Drill ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=3+strokes+6+kicks+drill+body+rotation+freestyle+triathlon	HOW: Take 3 strokes, pause in the side-kick position for 3 kicks, take 3 more strokes, pause on the other side.	WHY: Locks in the feeling of hip drive leading the stroke. If you pause without sinking, your balance is improving.	4x50 @1:30 — Thu warm-up, Wks 6+
--	--	--	---

KICK EFFICIENCY — Endurance saver			
Kickboard 50s ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=kickboard+kick+drill+freestyle+triathlon+hip+kick	HOW: Arms on kickboard, kick from the hip (not the knee). Toes pointed, small rapid flutter. Keep hips at the surface.	WHY: Weak kick wastes energy and sinks your hips — both slow you down. A compact 2-beat kick conserves energy for the bike + run.	4-6x50 @1:15 — Thu PRE-SET every week
Vertical Kicking ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=vertical+kicking+drill+swimming+triathlon+deep+end	HOW: In the deep end, hold arms crossed on chest and kick to keep your head above water for 30s.	WHY: The hardest kick drill — rapidly strengthens hip flexors and ankle flexibility. Do this and your kick will improve in 4 weeks.	3x30s with 30s rest — Thu, Wks 8-20

PACING & OPEN WATER — Race-day skills			
Descending 100s ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=descending+intervals+freestyle+swimming+triathlon+pacing	HOW: Swim 4x100. Each one faster than the last. Rep 1 = easy, Rep 4 = near race pace.	WHY: Teaches you not to go out too fast in a triathlon swim. Most triathletes positive-split their swim — this trains the opposite.	4x100 descending — Tue MAIN SET, Wks 10+
Sighting Drill ■ you.tu.be/i6-w8RXf45Y	HOW: Every 6-8 strokes, lift only your eyes (not your head) forward to spot a landmark, then immediately return face to water.	WHY: Lifting your full head drops your hips and adds drag. Eyes-only sighting is the open water skill that separates smooth swimmers from choppy ones.	4x50 @1:30 — Thu warm-up, Wks 11+ (race blocks)
Bilateral Breathing ■ youtube.com/results?search_query=bilateral+breathing+every+3+strokes+freestyle+triathlon+swimming	HOW: Breathe every 3 strokes, alternating sides. If you normally breathe every 2 strokes to one side, this will feel hard at first.	WHY: One-side breathing creates muscle imbalance and makes you swim in a curve in open water. Bilateral fixes both issues.	All endurance sets — every session from Wk 1

HOW TO USE THESE DRILLS IN YOUR TUE / THU SESSIONS			
TUE (all blocks)	2x Catch drills — Catch-Up + Fingertip Drag 4x50 each @ 1:30	Endurance sets — apply high-elbow catch throughout	1,200-2,500m
THU (Blks 1-2)	Kickboard 50s (4x50) + Side Kick Drill 4x50 each @1:15	Speed sets — focus on hip rotation driving each stroke	1,000-1,500m
THU (Blks 3-5)	Sighting Drill + Vertical Kicking 4x50 sighting + 3x30s vertical	Race-pace sets — descending 100s, open water sim	1,500-2,000m

NUTRITION PLAN - HYBRID ATHLETE FUELING

Your existing meals are excellent for hybrid training. This plan optimizes timing and fills gaps. Target: Protein 0.8-1g x bodyweight (lbs) - Carbs 2-3g x bodyweight - Fats 0.4g x bodyweight.

PRE-WORKOUT (5:15-5:45 AM — 15-20 min before training)

Creatine	3-5g creatine monohydrate mixed in water or juice	~5g creatine
Note:	Take daily — consistency matters more than timing. On rest days take it with any meal. Creatine improves strength, power output and recovery. No loading phase needed.	
Tea or Coffee	1-2 cups green/black tea OR coffee (black preferred)	~80-200mg caffeine
Note:	Both work well. Tea = smoother sustained energy, less crash. Coffee = stronger kick for heavy lift days. At 5:30am starts, caffeine is your friend — no need to worry about sleep cutoff.	
Optional: Half banana	If stomach feels empty at 5am	~15g fast carbs
Note:	Only if you feel low energy going in. Many athletes train fasted at this hour comfortably — listen to your body.	

POST-WORKOUT (within 30-45 min of finishing)

Your Overnight Oats	Oats + nuts + mixed berries + half banana + milk + protein powder + cinnamon	~450-550 cal - 35g P - 55g C - 12g F
Note:	Perfect post-workout meal. The protein powder hits fast, oats replenish glycogen, berries provide antioxidants to fight training inflammation. Cinnamon improves insulin sensitivity for better nutrient uptake. Add an extra scoop protein on heavy lift days or after long Saturday efforts.	
Extra Protein if needed	Add second scoop whey OR a Pure Protein bar on top	~20-25g extra protein
Note:	On Mon/Wed/Fri (strength AM + cardio PM): aim for 40-50g protein post-workout to cover both sessions. The oats alone with one scoop may not be enough on these days.	

LUNCH OPTIONS - Rotate Daily for Variety

Chicken Shawarma Plate (your go-to)	Chicken + rice + salad + tahini	~650 cal - 45g P - 60g C - 15g F
Note:	Your staple. Add extra rice on Mon/Wed/Fri cardio days. Olive oil on salad for healthy fats.	
MEDITERRANEAN - Greek Bowl	Grilled chicken or lamb + tzatziki + pita + cucumber-tomato salad + hummus	~620 cal - 42g P - 58g C - 14g F
Note:	Request extra protein. Hummus adds healthy fats + plant protein. Skip pita on rest days.	
MEDITERRANEAN - Falafel Plate	4-5 falafel + rice or pita + fattoush salad + hummus + tahini drizzle	~580 cal - 22g P - 70g C - 18g F
Note:	Lower protein day - add a protein shake post-lunch to compensate. High-carb: great before PM run.	
MEDITERRANEAN - Grilled Fish Plate	Grilled branzino or sea bass + tabbouleh + roasted veggies + lemon-olive oil	~530 cal - 44g P - 38g C - 16g F
Note:	Excellent omega-3 source. Light on carbs - add a side of pita or rice on training days.	
INDIAN - Chicken Tikka Masala Bowl	Chicken tikka + basmati rice + dal + side salad	~680 cal - 48g P - 65g C - 14g F
Note:	Anti-inflammatory spices (turmeric, ginger) support recovery. Ask for extra chicken.	
INDIAN - Tandoori Chicken + Dal	Tandoori chicken (2 pieces) + chana or moong dal + 0.5 cup rice or roti	~620 cal - 50g P - 55g C - 12g F
Note:	High protein, lean option. Dal adds fiber + plant protein. Great on lift days.	
INDIAN - Paneer Bowl (veg option)	Paneer bhurji or palak paneer + 2 rotis or rice + dal + raita	~590 cal - 30g P - 60g C - 16g F
Note:	Good vegetarian day. Paneer = complete protein. Add a protein bar after to hit targets.	
MEXICAN - Chicken Burrito Bowl	Grilled chicken + cilantro rice + black beans + pico + guacamole + Greek yogurt (sub sour cream)	~680 cal - 48g P - 62g C - 16g F
Note:	Power hybrid meal. Black beans + chicken = protein stack. Guac adds healthy fats. Skip cheese if watching cals.	
MEXICAN - Carne Asada Tacos (3)	Lean carne asada + corn tortillas + pico + onion + cilantro + avocado	~600 cal - 40g P - 55g C - 18g F
Note:	Corn tortillas are gluten-free, easier to digest pre-training. Load up on protein, go light on cheese.	
MEXICAN - Shrimp Fajita Bowl	Grilled shrimp + sauteed peppers + rice + black beans + salsa + avocado	~580 cal - 38g P - 58g C - 14g F
Note:	Shrimp is low-cal, high-protein. Great lighter lunch option on deload or rest days.	
Hydration (every lunch)	500ml water + electrolytes with every meal	--

Note:	Non-negotiable on Mon/Wed/Fri (lift AM + cardio PM). Add electrolyte tabs, not just plain water.
--------------	--

SNACKS

Pure Protein Bar	1 bar mid-morning or mid-afternoon	~20g P - ~25g C - ~5g F
Note:	Best 60-90 min before PM run/bike/swim. Fast protein + moderate carbs = clean fuel. Good on Mon/Wed/Fri when you have a PM session after a morning lift.	
RXBAR	1 bar as alternative to Pure Protein	~12g P - ~23g C - ~9g F
Note:	Whole food ingredients (dates, egg whites, nuts) — easier to digest, no artificial stuff. Lower protein than Pure Protein so better as a snack than a protein hit. Great pre-PM cardio or as a mid-morning snack post-oats.	
Apple or Banana + Nut Butter	1 fruit + 1 tbsp almond or peanut butter	~25-30g C - 4g P - 8g F
Note:	Fast carbs for PM cardio. Nut butter slows digestion on rest days. Pair with an RXBAR if you need more protein.	
Greek Yogurt + Honey	1 cup Greek yogurt + drizzle honey + handful of nuts	~20g P - 25g C - 8g F
Note:	Mediterranean-style snack. Great on swim days or when you want something more substantial than a bar.	
Roasted Chickpeas	100g roasted masala or spiced chickpeas	~15g P - 30g C - 6g F
Note:	Indian-spiced versions are satisfying and high-fiber. Good on rest days instead of a protein bar.	

DINNER — Rotate for Variety (Med / Indian / Mexican)

MED: Grilled Salmon + Quinoa + Greek Salad	Salmon + quinoa + cucumber-tomato-feta salad + olive oil	~580 cal - 50g P - 38g C - 18g F
Note:	Omega-3s reduce training inflammation. Best after Mon/Wed/Fri two-a-days.	
MED: Lamb Kofta + Tabbouleh + Hummus	2-3 kofta skewers + tabbouleh + hummus + pita	~620 cal - 44g P - 52g C - 18g F
Note:	Iron-rich lamb = great for endurance. High-carb: eat after long Saturday sessions.	
MED: Baked Cod + Roasted Veggies + Couscous	Cod fillet + roasted peppers/zucchini + couscous + olive oil drizzle	~510 cal - 44g P - 42g C - 10g F
Note:	Light and easy to digest. Good night before a race or on deload days.	
INDIAN: Butter Chicken + Roti	Butter chicken (lean, less cream) + 2 whole wheat roti + side salad	~640 cal - 50g P - 50g C - 16g F
Note:	Anti-inflammatory tomato + spice base. Great recovery meal post-run.	
INDIAN: Tandoori Chicken + Rice	Tandoori chicken 2 pieces + basmati rice + raita	~600 cal - 52g P - 48g C - 10g F
Note:	Lean, high-protein. Perfect on lift days. Ask for extra chicken.	
INDIAN: Palak Paneer + Grilled Chicken + Rice	Palak paneer + grilled chicken breast + basmati rice	~620 cal - 55g P - 48g C - 14g F
Note:	Spinach = iron + magnesium for endurance. Best post-swim dinner.	
MEXICAN: Chicken Burrito Bowl	Grilled chicken + cilantro rice + black beans + pico + guac	~680 cal - 48g P - 62g C - 16g F
Note:	High-carb power meal. Perfect after long Saturday efforts or peak weeks.	
MEXICAN: Carne Asada + Black Beans + Rice	Lean flank steak + black beans + Mexican rice + salsa	~650 cal - 52g P - 48g C - 18g F
Note:	Iron-rich. Black beans add fiber + plant protein. Great strength day dinner.	
MEXICAN: Shrimp Tacos (3) + Slaw + Avocado	Grilled shrimp + corn tortillas + cabbage slaw + avocado	~560 cal - 38g P - 50g C - 16g F
Note:	Lighter option. Good on easy days or before a morning race.	

PRE-BED (heavy training days only)

Casein / Cottage Cheese	1 cup cottage cheese OR casein shake	~25-30g slow protein
Note:	Slow-digesting protein feeds muscle overnight. Best after Mon/Wed/Fri lifts and Saturday long efforts.	

RACE-DAY NUTRITION STRATEGIES

TRIATHLON RACE DAY

Night Before	Big carb meal: chicken shawarma + extra rice + daal. No raw salad. 500ml electrolyte water.
2 hrs before	Overnight oats - your usual breakfast. Familiar, tested, works.
30 min before	Half banana + coffee/caffeine. Zero new foods race morning.
During Race	Gel every 30-40 min on bike/run for events >60 min. Water at every aid station.
Recovery	Protein shake within 30 min of finish + full meal within 2 hours.

SPARTAN / OCF RACE DAY

Night Before	Same as triathlon: carb-heavy, clean, no fiber bombs.
2 hrs before	Overnight oats + extra protein scoop.
30 min before	Energy gel or banana. Caffeine 200mg if using.
During Race	Sprint: nothing needed. Super/Beast: 1-2 gels + electrolytes at stations.
Recovery	Protein + carbs ASAP post-finish. Your shawarma plate is perfect here.

DEKA RACE DAY

2 hrs before	Light oats, no heavy foods. Stomach needs to be clear for high-intensity zones.
30 min before	Gel or gummy chews + electrolyte drink.
During	Typically 20-40 min event - nothing needed during. Hydrate between attempts.
Recovery	Full protein meal within 1 hour. Daal + protein + rice.

YOUR 2026 RACE CALENDAR & GOALS

Mar 15 ✓	Deka Strong	DEKA	DONE	COMPLETED — 25:30 baseline set ✓
Apr 25	Deka Fit - Sacramento	DEKA	BLK 1	Sub 22:00 — beat Deka Strong by 3+ min
May 9	Deka Mile	DEKA	BLK 2	Sub 28:00 — strong pacing across all 10 zones
May 30	Spartan Super - Salinas	OCF 13km	BLK 2	Zero penalty burpees — complete every obstacle
May 31	Spartan Sprint - Salinas	OCF 5km	BLK 2	Sub 45 min — strong finish on tired legs
Aug 9	Tri Santa Cruz	Triathlon	BLK 3	Sprint: sub 1:25 Olympic: sub 2:50
Sep 13	Santa Cruz 70.3 Swim Relay	Swim Relay	BLK 4	Sub 48 min (1.9km leg @ 2:30/100m)
Sep 27	Olympic/Sprint Triathlon	Triathlon	BLK 4	Sub 2:45 Olympic — 27 min PR vs 2022
Nov 7	Spartan Beast - 21k	OCF Beast	BLK 5	Finish top 25% of age group — <4:30
Nov 8	Spartan Sprint - 5k	OCF Sprint	BLK 5	Sub 40 min — finish the season on fire!

RACE GOALS — WHAT EACH ONE MEANS

DEKA FIT — APR 25	TARGET: Sub 22:00
You ran 25:30 on Deka Strong with zero DEKA-specific training. After 5 weeks of targeted Row, SkiErg, and zone work, sub 22:00 is very realistic. That's shaving ~30 seconds per zone — totally doable with proper pacing and zone transitions.	
DEKA MILE — MAY 9	TARGET: Sub 28:00
The Deka Mile is longer (full 1-mile run per zone vs shorter runs), so a 28-min target accounts for the added distance. Focus on pacing the run segments early — don't blow up in zones 1-3. Your aerobic engine from training will carry you.	
SPARTAN SUPER — MAY 30	TARGET: Zero Penalty Burpees
13km is a long day — the goal isn't about time, it's about clean obstacle completion. You have 5 weeks of grip work, rope climbs, and carry training baked in. Prioritize obstacles over speed. A clean run with zero burpees is a huge win for your first Super.	
SPARTAN SPRINT — MAY 31	TARGET: Sub 45 min
Day 2 of a back-to-back weekend. Your legs WILL be tired — that's part of the challenge. Sub 45 on tired legs from a Super the day before is a badge of toughness. Go out controlled, get stronger as the race progresses.	
TRI SANTA CRUZ — AUG 9	TARGET: Sprint: Sub 1:25 Olympic: Sub 2:50
Your current fitness translates directly: 5km run = 28 min, swim pace = 2:42/100m. For a Sprint (750m swim + 20km bike + 5km): target 18 min swim + 35 min bike + 29 min run + transitions = ~1:25. For Olympic: 38 min swim + 1:10 bike + 58 min run = ~2:50. Either way, a 20+ minute PR over your 2022 time is on the table.	
70.3 SWIM RELAY — SEP 13	TARGET: Sub 48 min (1.9km swim leg)
The 70.3 swim is 1.9km. At your current 2:42/100m pace that projects to ~51 min. With 9 weeks of focused swim training you can bring that to sub-2:30/100m, putting you right at 48 min. Focus on sighting every 8-10 strokes and negative splitting — stronger second half sets up your relay team.	
OLYMPIC TRIATHLON — SEP 27	TARGET: Sub 2:45 (vs 3:12:25 in 2022)
Your numbers tell the story — swim: 41:38 in 2022 vs current 2:42/100m pace = ~40 min for 1500m. Run: 1:01:40 in 2022 vs current 5:36/km = ~58 min for 10km (3+ min improvement). Bike target 1:08 (up from 1:22 with training). Transitions: cut from 6:48 to under 4 min. Add it up: 40 + 2 + 1:08 + 1:30 + 58 = 2:49. Push hard and sub 2:45 is yours.	
SPARTAN BEAST — NOV 7	TARGET: Top 25% Age Group — Sub 4:30
21km is the biggest OCF event of your year. You'll have 6 weeks of beast-specific prep plus the strength and endurance base from the entire season behind you. Sub 4:30 puts you in the top quarter. Strategy: run easy for the first 8km, then push. Carry heavy with your legs not your back.	
SPARTAN SPRINT — NOV 8	TARGET: Sub 40 min — Finish the Season
Last race of 2026. Legs will be sore from Beast but 5km is pure grit. At your current 5:36/km run pace, a fresh 5km = 28 min. Even at 7:45/km on Beast-tired legs that's sub 40 min. Use the crowd energy. This is your victory lap for an incredible season — leave nothing on the course.	

BLOCK 1	BLOCK 2	BLOCK 3	BLOCK 4	BLOCK 5
Mar 23 - Apr 19 4 weeks DEKA Fit Prep	Apr 20 - May 31 6 weeks DEKA + Salinas	Jun 1 - Aug 2 9 weeks Triathlon Base	Aug 3 - Sep 28 8 weeks Triathlon Races	Sep 29 - Nov 8 6 weeks Spartan Beast

BLOCK 1 — DEKA FIT PREP

Mar 23 — Apr 19, 2026 | Build strength and DEKA-specific fitness coming off Deka Strong (25:30). Target: beat that time at DEKA Fit Apr 25.

RACES: DEKA Fit - Apr 25 (Wk 5)

WK 1 Mar 23-29 — Pre-race sharpening — Spartan Sprint in 12 days

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength - Taper Load - Squat 3x6 @70% - Bench 3x6 @70% - Pull-Up 3x6 - Farmers Carry 3x30m <i>Run PM: 20min easy + 4x200m strides</i>	Swim - Technique - 25min technique focus - Catch-up + fingertip drills - Easy pace, no fatigue	Strength - Taper - RDL 3x6 @70% - OHP 3x6 - Split Squat 3x8 ea - KB Swing 3x12 <i>Easy bike 25min Zone 2</i>	Swim + OCF Sharpening - 20min easy swim - Rope hang 3x30s - Sandbag carry 3x30m (20lb — intro) - Burpee practice 3x8 <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Light Strength 60% - Main lifts only 3x5 @60% - Plank 2x30s - No fatigue today <i>Rest PM</i>	Short Run + Obstacles - 30min Zone 2 easy run - 4x obstacle simulations - Grip + carry + crawl - Gear check	Full Rest - Sleep 8+ hrs - Visualize Spartan Sprint - Gear layout + prep - Hydrate 3L

WK 2 Mar 30 - Apr 5 — Base build — DEKA Fit pivot, Apr 25 target

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 72% - Squat 4x6 @72% - Bench 4x6 @72% - Pull-Up 4x6 - Box Jump 3x5 <i>Run PM: 6x400m @RPE 8</i>	Swim + DEKA Intro - 25min swim - Row Erg 3x200m easy - SkiErg 3x200m easy - Learn zone transitions	Strength 72% - RDL 4x6 @72% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Sled Push 3x20m <i>Bike 35min + run 10min brick</i>	Swim + DEKA Drills - 25min swim - Row 3x250m @80% - SkiErg 3x250m @80% - Burpee practice 3x10 <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 72% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Pull-Up 4x6 - Farmers Carry 4x35m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	DEKA Simulation - Full 10-zone DEKA circuit - Row + Ski + Burpee Box Jump + Sled + Run - 2 timed attempts - Note weak zones	Active Recovery - 30min easy walk - Full foam roll 15min - Review DEKA weak zones - Plan Week 3

WK 3 Apr 6-12 — Recovery + DEKA Fit pivot — Race Apr 25

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength - Recovery - Squat 3x8 @65% - Bench 3x8 @65% - Pull-Up 3x8 - No power work <i>Easy jog 20min Zone 2</i>	Swim + DEKA Intro - 30min swim - DEKA zone preview: Row + Ski - 2x100m row easy - 2x100m SkiErg easy	Strength 70% - RDL 3x8 @70% - OHP 3x8 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Sled Push 2x20m (light) <i>Bike 30min Zone 2</i>	Swim + DEKA Drills - 25min swim - Row Erg 3x200m - SkiErg 3x200m - Burpee practice 3x10 <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 70% - Squat 3x8 @70% - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Farmers Carry 3x35m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	DEKA Simulation - 10-zone DEKA circuit - Row + Ski + Burpee Box Jump + Sled + Run - 2 full attempts - Note weak zones	Active Recovery - 30min easy walk - Full foam roll 15min - Review DEKA weak zones - Plan Week 4

WK 4 Apr 13-19 — DEKA Fit build — Race Apr 25

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength - DEKA Focus - Squat 4x6 @75% - Bench 4x6 @75% - Pull-Up 4x6 - Sled Push 3x25m <i>Run PM: 6x400m @RPE 8</i>	Swim + DEKA Zones - 30min swim - Row 3x250m @85% - SkiErg 3x250m @85% - Burpee Box Jump 3x8	Strength 75% - RDL 4x6 @75% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Farmers Carry 4x40m <i>Bike 35min Zone 2-3</i>	Swim + Full DEKA Sim - 20min swim - Full DEKA 10-zone circuit - 1 timed attempt - Record splits per zone <i>SPIN PM: Easy 30 min @Zone 2 — deload</i>	Light Strength 65% - All lifts 3x5 @65% - Stay fresh for race - No grinding sets <i>Rest PM</i>	DEKA Practice Race - Second timed DEKA sim - Aim to beat Wk3 score - Practice zone transitions - Nutrition practice	Rest + DEKA Prep - Full rest - Review zone times - Plan race strategy - Visualize DEKA Fit

BLOCK 2 — DEKA + SALINAS

Apr 20 — May 31, 2026 | Three DEKA races + back-to-back Spartan Super/Sprint weekend. Peak OCF fitness of the year.

RACES: DEKA Fit - Apr 25 (Wk 5) DEKA Mile - May 9 (Wk 7) | Spartan Super+Sprint - May 30-31 (Wk 10)

WK 5 Apr 20-26 — TAPER — DEKA Fit Sacramento Apr 25 RACE: DEKA Fit - Apr 25

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 60% - Squat 3x5 @60% - Bench 3x5 @60% - Pull-Up 3x5 - Keep short 25min <i>Easy run 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy laps - 2x100m @ DEKA pace - Stay fresh	Light Strength 55% - 2x5 all lifts @55% - 15-20 min total - Feel good, stop <i>Easy bike 20min</i>	Short Swim + Strides - 15min easy swim - 4x100m strides on land - Legs should feel snappy <i>SPIN: Easy 30 min only — DEKA Fit race Sat</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-up dinner - Gear ready - Sleep 8+ hrs	DEKA FIT - RACE - RACE DAY - Sacramento - Warm-up: row + ski easy 5min - Execute all 10 zones - Beat Deka Strong time!	Recovery - Easy 20min walk - 30min roll + stretch - Protein + carbs - Rest well

WK 6 Apr 27 - May 3 — Recovery + DEKA Mile build — Race May 9

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 70% - Squat 3x8 @70% - Bench 3x8 @70% - Pull-Up 3x8 - KB Swing 3x12 <i>Run PM: 30min Zone 2</i>	Swim + DEKA Endurance - 30min swim - Row 4x300m - SkiErg 4x300m - Note: DEKA Mile is longer effort	Strength 72% - RDL 3x8 @72% - OHP 3x8 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Sled Push 3x20m <i>Bike 35min Zone 2</i>	Swim + DEKA Mile Prep - 25min swim - Row 1x500m easy - SkiErg 1x500m easy - Pacing practice <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 72% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Farmers Carry 3x40m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	DEKA Mile Simulation - Full DEKA Mile circuit practice - Focus on pacing (longer effort) - Row 500m + all 10 zones - Record splits	Active Recovery - 30min walk - Foam roll 15min - Review DEKA Mile pacing - Meal prep

WK 7 May 4-10 — TAPER — DEKA Mile May 9 RACE: DEKA Mile - May 9

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 60% - Squat 3x5 @60% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - Short 20min <i>Easy run 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy - 2x200m @ DEKA pace - Fresh legs priority	Very Light 55% - 2x5 @55% all lifts - 15 min total - Stop feeling good <i>Easy bike 15min</i>	Light Swim - 15min easy swim - Light movement - No zone work <i>SPIN: Easy 30 min only — DEKA Mile race Sat</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-heavy dinner - Gear check - Sleep 9hrs	DEKA MILE - RACE - RACE DAY - DEKA Mile - Warm-up each zone briefly - Pace conservatively early - Strong finish!	Recovery - Easy walk 20min - Stretch + foam roll - Good nutrition day - Rest

WK 8 May 11-17 — Recovery + Salinas build

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 72% - Squat 4x6 @72% - Bench 4x6 - Pull-Up 4x6 - Box Jump 3x5 <i>Run PM: 6x400m @RPE 8</i>	Swim + OCF Return - 30min swim - Rope hang 3x30s - Sandbag carry 4x40m (30lb — build) - Grip + pull prep	Strength 75% - RDL 4x6 @75% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - KB Swing 4x15 <i>Bike 40min + run 10min brick</i>	Swim + Spartan Sim - 25min swim - Full obstacle circuit 20min - Rope + carry + crawl + burpee <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 75% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Farmers Carry 4x40m - Sandbag carry 3x40m (30lb) <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Long Trail Run - 60min trail run Zone 2-3 - Include 15min obstacle work - Grip + carry mid-run - Practice fueling	Active Recovery - 30min walk or easy swim - Foam roll IT band + glutes - Plan Salinas race weekend

WK 9 May 18-24 — Salinas peak build — Super May 30 + Sprint May 31

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 @78% - Bench 4x6 @78% - Weighted Pull-Up 4x5 - Towel Pull-Up 3x6 (grip) <i>Run PM: Tempo 25min @RPE 7</i>	Swim + Heavy OCF - 30min swim - Sandbag squat 4x10 (35lb M25lb W) - Rope climb 5x3 - Bucket carry sim 3x40m	Strength 78% - RDL 4x6 @78% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea (heavy) - Sled Push 4x25m <i>Bike 45min + run 15min brick</i>	Swim + Full Spartan Sim - 25min swim - Full Spartan circuit 30min - Rope + carry + crawl + burpee + throw - Score rounds <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Light Strength 65% - All lifts 3x5 @65% - Stay fresh - No grinding <i>Rest PM</i>	Race Sim - Super Distance - Trail run 13km simulation - Include obstacles every 2km - Spartan Super race nutrition practice - Finish strong	Rest + Strategy - Full rest - Plan Super vs Sprint strategy - Gear for double weekend - Visualize both races

WK 10 May 25-31 — RACE WEEKEND — Super May 30 + Sprint May 31 RACE: Spartan Super+Sprint

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Light Strength 60% - Squat 2x5 @60% - Bench 2x5 - Pull-Up 2x5 - 10min total <i>Easy run 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 15min easy swim only - Stay fresh - No intervals	Very Light 55% - 2x5 @55% all main lifts - 15min only - Feel fast <i>Easy bike 15min</i>	Short Swim + Light OCF - 15min easy swim - Light grip work 2x20s hang - Sandbag 2x20m (20lb — taper light) <i>SKIP SPIN — Spartan Super+Sprint race weekend</i>	REST - FULL REST - Carb-load dinner - Gear for BOTH races ready - Sleep 9hrs	SPARTAN SUPER - RACE - RACE DAY - Salinas 13km - Pace conservatively early - Gel every 40min on course - Save legs for tomorrow!	SPARTAN SPRINT - RACE - RACE DAY - Salinas 5km - Legs will be tired - it's OK - Go hard, it's only 5km - Sprint the finish!

BLOCK 3 — TRIATHLON BASE

RACES: Tri Santa Cruz - Aug 9 (Wk 19/20)

WK 11 Jun 1-7 — Post-Salinas recovery + Triathlon intro

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Recovery Strength 65% - Squat 3x8 @65% - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Light only <i>Easy jog 20min Zone 1-2</i>	Swim - Tri Technique - 30min easy swim - Focus: freestyle form - Bilateral breathing practice - No fatigue	Strength 68% - RDL 3x8 @68% - OHP 3x8 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - KB Swing 3x12 <i>Easy bike 30min Zone 2</i>	Swim - Base Build - 30min easy swim - Drill: pull buoy + paddles - Zone 2 effort only <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30</i> <i>PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i> <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Strength 68% - Squat 3x8 @68% - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Plank 3x45s <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Long Easy Bike - 60min Zone 2 easy bike - Cadence 85-90rpm - Practice tri nutrition - Foam roll after	Active Recovery - Easy swim 20min float - 30min walk - Hip + shoulder mobility - Meal prep

WK 12 Jun 8-14 — Triathlon base — swim + bike volume build

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 70% - Squat 4x8 @70% - Bench 4x8 - Pull-Up 4x8 - Box Jump 4x5 <i>Run PM: 30min Zone 2 easy</i>	Swim - Base - 35min swim - 400m warm-up + 6x50m drills + 200m cool - Focus: catch + pull	Strength 70% - RDL 4x8 @70% - OHP 4x8 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Hip Thrust 3x12 <i>Bike 40min + run 10min brick</i>	Swim - Endurance - 35min steady swim - 2x400m @Zone 2-3 - Rest 60s between - Note pace <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 70% - Squat 4x8 - Bench 4x8 - Weighted Pull-Up 4x6 - Farmers Carry 4x35m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Bike - 75min Zone 2-3 - Practice nutrition every 30min - Post-ride run 15min - Record pace	Active Recovery - Easy swim 20min - 30min walk - Foam roll full body

WK 13 Jun 15-21 — Tri base — introduce speed work

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 72% - Squat 4x8 @72% - Bench 4x8 - Pull-Up 4x8 - KB Swing 4x12 <i>Run PM: 8x400m @RPE 8</i>	Swim - Speed Intro - 400m warm-up - 4x100m @RPE 7 - 200m cool - Total 35min	Strength 72% - RDL 4x8 @72% - OHP 4x8 - Split Squat 4x10 ea - Hip Thrust 4x10 <i>Bike 45min Zone 3 + run 15min</i>	Swim - Endurance - 40min swim - 3x400m @Zone 3 - 90s rest each - Strong pull focus <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 72% - Squat 4x8 - Bench 4x8 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x6 - Sled Push 3x20m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Run - 60min Zone 2 - Last 15min @Zone 3 - Race shoes practice - Hydrate every 15min	Recovery - Easy swim 20min - Foam roll + mobility - Hip flexors + calves

WK 14 Jun 22-28 — Tri build — brick sessions intensify

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 75% - Squat 4x6 @75% - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Box Jump 4x5 <i>Run PM: Tempo 25min @RPE 7</i>	Swim - Race Pace - 100m warm-up - 5x100m @race pace - 200m cool - Total 40min	Strength 75% - RDL 4x6 @75% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Hip Thrust 4x10 <i>Bike 50min + run 20min brick</i>	Swim - Endurance - 45min swim - 800m time trial - Note split - Compare to wk 12 <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 75% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Farmers Carry 4x40m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Brick - Longer - Bike 75min Zone 2-3 - Run 25min immediately - Push last 5min of run - Nutrition practice	Recovery - 30min easy swim - Foam roll - Plan fueling strategy for Santa Cruz

WK 15 Jun 29 - Jul 5 — Tri build — peak volume approaching

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 @ 78% - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Power Clean 3x4 <i>Run PM: 6x400m @RPE 8-9</i>	Swim - Volume - 45min swim - 400m + 6x100m @race pace + 200m - Total 1200m set	Strength 78% - RDL 4x6 @ 78% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Hip Thrust 4x10 <i>Bike 55min + run 20min brick</i>	Swim - Endurance - 45min swim - 1000m continuous @Zone 3 - Rest 2min + 4x50m fast <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Farmers Carry 4x45m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Bike - 90min Zone 2-3 - Brick run 25min - 2 gels practice - Record total time	Recovery - Easy swim 25min - Full foam roll - Ice bath if available

WK 16 | Jul 6-12 — DELOAD week — active recovery

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Deload Strength 65% - Squat 3x5 @65% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - Short 20min <i>Easy run 25min Zone 2</i>	Swim - Easy - 30min easy technique - Drill focus only - No intensity	Deload Strength 65% - RDL 3x5 @65% - OHP 3x5 - Split Squat 2x8 ea - Light KB <i>Easy bike 30min Zone 2</i>	Swim - Easy - 30min easy - Freestyle + backstroke mix - Relax and recover <i>SPIN PM: Easy 30 min @Zone 2 — deload</i>	Deload Strength 65% - All lifts 3x5 @65% - 25min total - Feel good <i>Easy bike 20min</i>	Fitness Test - Swim 400m time trial - Bike 30min @tempo - Run 20min @tempo - Record all splits vs Week 12	Full Rest - Sleep 9hrs - Meal prep - Recovery priority

WK 17 | Jul 13-19 — Fri build phase 2 — Intensity up

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 80% - Squat 5x4 @80% - Bench 5x4 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x4 - Box Jump 4x5 <i>Run PM: 4x800m @RPE 8</i>	Swim - Speed - 400m warm-up - 8x100m @race pace (15s rest) - 200m cool - Fastest swim yet	Strength 80% - RDL 5x4 @80% - OHP 5x4 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Hip Thrust 4x10 <i>Bike 60min Zone 3 + run 25min</i>	Swim - Open Water Sim - 45min open water or pool - 1500m continuous if possible - Sighting practice - Stay relaxed <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 80% - Squat 5x4 - Bench 5x4 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x4 - Farmers Carry 5x45m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Brick - Bike 90min Zone 3 - Run 30min immediately - Last 10min run @race pace - Record splits	Recovery - Easy swim 25min - Foam roll 20min - Cold shower

WK 18 Jul 20-26 — Peak triathlon week — heaviest load

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 83% - Squat 5x3 @83% - Bench 5x3 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x3 - Power Clean 4x3 <i>Run PM: Tempo 30min @RPE 7-8</i>	Swim - Race Sim - 500m warm-up - Race distance simulation - Sprint finish practice - Total 50min	Strength 83% - RDL 5x3 @83% - OHP 5x3 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Hip Thrust 5x8 <i>Bike 70min + run 30min brick</i>	Swim - Hard - 50min swim - 2x750m @Zone 4 - 2min rest between - Record splits <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 83% - Squat 5x3 - Bench 5x3 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x3 - Farmers Carry 5x50m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	LONGEST TRI SESSION - Bike 100min Zone 3 - Run 35min immediately - Full nutrition protocol - Dress rehearsal	Mandatory Rest - No training - Sleep 9hrs - Ice / contrast shower - Review Santa Cruz race info

WK 19 | Jul 27 - Aug 2 — TAPER — Ill Santa Cruz Aug 9

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Taper Strength 70% - Squat 3x5 @70% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 30min max <i>Run PM: 4x200m @race pace</i>	Swim - Sharp - 30min swim - 4x100m @race pace - Feel fast, stop	Light Strength 68% - All lifts 3x5 @68% - 25min total <i>Easy bike 25min opener</i>	Swim + Strides - 20min easy swim - 4x100m strides on land - Legs should feel fresh <i>SPIN: Easy 30 min only — Tri Santa Cruz taper</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-heavy dinner - Gear and race kit ready - Sleep 9hrs	Pre-race Openers - 10min easy jog - 4 strides @race pace - Swim 10min easy - Then rest	TRI SANTA CRUZ - RACE - RACE DAY! - Warm-up: 5min easy swim - Execute your tri race plan - Have fun - first triathlon!

BLOCK 4 — TRIATHLON RACES

Aug 3 – Sep 28, 2026 | Execute three triathlon events. Recovery + rebuild between races. Swim relay and Olympic tri.

RACES: Tri Santa Cruz - Aug 9 (Wk 20) | 70.3 Swim Relay - Sep 13 (Wk 25) | Olympic Tri - Sep 27 (Wk 27)

WK 20	Aug 3-9 — RACE WEEK — Tri Santa Cruz Aug 9 RACE: Tri Santa Cruz - Aug 9
--------------	--

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Taper Strength 65% - Squat 3x5 @65% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 20min only <i>Easy run 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy swim - 2x100m race pace - Stay fresh	Very Light 60% - 2x5 @60% all lifts - 15min max - Feel good, walk out <i>Easy bike 20min</i>	Short Swim - 15min easy only - Relax in water - Light movement <i>SKIP SPIN — Tri Santa Cruz race week</i>	REST - Full rest - Race nutrition prep - Gear check - Sleep 9hrs	Pre-race Openers - 10min jog + 4 strides - 10min easy swim sighting - Rack bike at transition - REST	TRI SANTA CRUZ - RACE - RACE DAY! - Execute race plan - Swim strong - set pace - Bike smart, run strong

WK 21	Aug 10-16 — Recovery + 70.3 Swim Relay prep
--------------	--

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Recovery Strength 65% - Squat 3x8 @65% - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Easy only <i>Easy jog 20min</i>	Swim - Recovery - 25min easy only - No pace targets - Feel the water - Relax	Strength 68% - RDL 3x8 @68% - OHP 3x8 - Split Squat 3x8 ea - Light KB 3x12 <i>Easy bike 30min Zone 2</i>	Swim - Relay Focus - 35min swim - 1500m continuous (relay distance) - Note pace per 500m - Swim relay = ~750-1900m <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 70% - Squat 3x8 - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Farmers Carry 3x35m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Easy Long Run - 50min Zone 2 - No pressure - Mental recovery - Enjoy it	Active Recovery - Easy swim 20min - Foam roll 15min - Plan Sep 13 relay strategy

WK 22	Aug 17-23 — Tri rebuild — 70.3 Swim Relay in 4 weeks
--------------	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 75% - Squat 4x6 @75% - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Power Clean 3x4 <i>Run PM: 6x400m @RPE 8</i>	Swim - Relay Build - 400m warm-up - 3x500m @Zone 3-4 (relay pace) - 200m cool - Total 1900m set	Strength 75% - RDL 4x6 @75% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Hip Thrust 4x10 <i>Bike 50min Zone 3 + run 15min</i>	Swim - Volume - 50min swim - 1500m continuous @relay pace - Record splits every 500m <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 75% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Farmers Carry 4x40m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Bike + Swim - Bike 80min Zone 2-3 - Swim 30min at pool after - Relay swimmer needs swim fitness	Recovery - Easy swim 20min - Foam roll - Nutrition check

WK 23	Aug 24-30 — 70.3 peak — 2 weeks to relay
--------------	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 @78% - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Box Jump 4x5 <i>Run PM: Tempo 25min @RPE 7</i>	Swim - Race Sim - 500m warm-up - 2x750m @race effort - 2min rest - Total 2000m set	Strength 78% - RDL 4x6 @78% - OHP 4x6 - Split Squat 4x8 ea - Sled Push 3x25m <i>Bike 55min Zone 3 + run 20min</i>	Swim - Open Water - 50min open water if possible - Sighting drills - Drafting practice - Stay relaxed in chop <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Farmers Carry 4x45m <i>Easy bike 30min</i>	Long Run - 70min Zone 2-3 - Olympic tri Sep 27 in 4 weeks too - Building run base - Hydrate + gel practice	Recovery - Easy swim 30min - Foam roll 20min - Ice bath/contrast

WK 24	Aug 31 - Sep 6 — TAPER — 70.3 Swim Relay Sep 13
--------------	--

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Taper Strength 70% - Squat 3x5 @70% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 30min <i>Easy run 20min</i>	Swim - Sharp - 30min swim - 4x100m @relay race pace - Feel fast	Light Strength 65% - All lifts 3x5 @65% - 25min <i>Easy bike 20min opener</i>	Swim - Taper - 20min easy swim - 4x50m fast - Stay sharp <i>SPIN: Easy 30 min only — 70.3 Swim Relay taper</i>	REST - Full rest - Hydrate extra - Gear ready - Sleep 9hrs	Easy Openers - 15min easy jog - 10min easy swim - Relax and stay loose	Easy Day - Short 20min swim at easy pace - Rest for relay next week - Nothing hard

WK 25	Sep 7-13 — RACE WEEK — Santa Cruz 70.3 Swim Relay Sep 13 RACE: 70.3 Swim Relay - Sep 13
--------------	--

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Light Strength 60% - Squat 2x5 @60% - Bench 2x5 - Pull-Up 2x5 - 15min <i>Easy run 15min</i>	Swim - Race Tune - 20min easy - 3x100m @relay pace - Stay smooth	Very Light 55% - 2x5 @55% all lifts - 10min max <i>Easy bike 15min</i>	Short Swim - 15min easy only - Feel good in water <i>SKIP SPIN — 70.3 Swim Relay race week</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-up dinner - Relay team coordination - Sleep 9hrs	Pre-race Swim - 15min easy swim at race venue if possible - Course preview - Calm + confident	70.3 SWIM RELAY - RACE - RACE DAY - Swim Leg - Warm-up: 5-10min easy swim - Execute your swim leg - Hand off strong to relay team!

WK 26	Sep 14-20 — Recovery + Olympic Tri Taper — Race Sep 27
--------------	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Recovery Strength 65% - Squat 3x5 @65% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 20min easy <i>Easy jog 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy only - Let arms recover from relay - Technique focus	Light Strength 68% - RDL 3x5 @68% - OHP 3x5 - Split Squat 2x8 ea - Light only <i>Easy bike 25min opener</i>	Swim - Race Tune - 25min swim - 4x100m @Olympic tri pace - Stay sharp <i>SPIN: Easy 30 min only — Olympic Tri taper</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-up - Gear for Olympic/Sprint ready - Sleep 9hrs	Pre-race Openers - 10min easy jog + 4 strides - 10min easy swim - Easy bike 15min - Relax	OLYMPIC TRI - RACE - RACE DAY - Sep 27 - Execute full Swim-Bike-Run - Stronger than Santa Cruz! - Target sub 2:30 Olympic

WK 27	Sep 21-27 — RACE WEEK — Olympic/Sprint Triathlon Sep 27 RACE: Olympic Tri - Sep 27
--------------	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Light Strength 60% - Squat 2x5 @60% - Bench 2x5 - Pull-Up 2x5 - 15min <i>Easy run 15min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy + 4x50m @race pace - Stay fresh	Very Light 55% - 2x5 @55% all lifts - 10min only <i>Easy bike 15min</i>	Short Swim - 15min easy - Shake the legs out <i>SKIP SPIN — Olympic Tri race week</i>	REST - Full rest - Race nutrition prep - Gear check - Sleep 9hrs	Openers - 10min jog + 4 strides - 10min easy swim - Relax and trust fitness	OLYMPIC TRI - RACE - RACE DAY! - Goal: sub 2:30 Olympic - Swim strong, bike smart - Run like you mean it

BLOCK 5 — SPARTAN BEAST PREP

Sep 29 – Nov 8, 2026 | Pivot back to OCF. Heavy strength, long trail runs, obstacle skills. Peak weeks 30-31, taper week 32.

RACES: Spartan Beast 21k - Nov 7 (Wk 33) | Spartan Sprint - Nov 8 (Wk 33)

WK 28	Sep 28 - Oct 4 — Recovery + Spartan Beast pivot
--------------	--

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Recovery Strength 65% - Squat 3x8 @65% - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Light only <i>Easy jog 20min</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy swim - Transition back to OCF mindset	Strength 70% - RDL 3x8 @70% - OHP 3x8 - Split Squat 3x10 ea - Sandbag intro 3x30m (25lb) <i>Easy trail run 30min</i>	Swim + OCF Return - 20min swim - Rope hang 3x30s - Sandbag carry 3x40m (30lb) - Bear crawl 3x20m <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 70% - Squat 3x8 - Bench 3x8 - Pull-Up 3x8 - Farmers Carry 3x40m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Long Trail Run - 60min trail run Zone 2 - Hills if available - OCF mindset back - Carry pack 5lb	Active Recovery - 30min walk - Foam roll - Plan Beast 21k strategy

WK 29 Oct 5-11 — Beast build — strength + trail

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 @78% - Bench 4x6 - Wtd Pull-Up 4x5 - Towel Pull-Up 3x6 <i>Run PM: Hill repeats 8x30s hard</i>	Swim + OCF Drills - 25min swim - Sandbag carry 4x40m (35lb → 40lb) - Rope climb 4x3 - Bucket carry 3x40m	Strength 78% - RDL 4x6 @78% - OHP 4x6 - Rope Climb 5x3 - Sled Push 4x25m <i>Bike 40min + run 15min brick</i>	Swim + Heavy OCF - 25min swim - Sandbag squat 4x10 (40lb M/30lb W — race weight) - Atlas stone sim 4x5 - Grip hang 3x40s <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 78% - Squat 4x6 - Bench 4x6 - Farmers Carry 5x40m - Yoke walk 3x20m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Long Trail Run - 75min trail run Zone 2-3 - Include obstacles mid-run - Sandbag carry (45lb M/35lb W race wt) + rope sim - Pace: sustainable Beast effort	Recovery - 30min walk - Foam roll IT band + glutes - Ice if sore

WK 30 Oct 12-18 — Beast build — peak volume

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength 82% - Squat 5x4 @82% - Bench 5x4 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x4 - KB Swing 5x15 <i>Run PM: Tempo 25min + 4x hill sprints</i>	Swim + Full OCF - 25min swim - Full Spartan circuit 25min - Rope + carry + crawl + burpee - Score rounds in 20min	Strength 82% - RDL 5x4 @82% - OHP 5x4 - Rope Climb 5x3 - Sled Push 4x30m <i>Bike 45min + trail run 20min</i>	Swim + OCF Heavy - 25min swim - Sandbag shoulder carry 5x50m (45lb M/35lb W — RACE WEIGHT) - Atlas stone 5x5 - Bucket carry 4x50m <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength 82% - Squat 5x4 - Bench 5x4 - Farmers Carry 5x50m - Yoke walk 4x20m <i>Easy bike 25min</i>	Long Trail Run - Beast Sim - 90min trail run with full kit - Obstacles every 20min - Gel every 40min - Note: Beast = 21km	Rest - Important - Full rest mandatory - Sleep 9hrs - Nutrition focus

WK 31 Oct 19-25 — Peak OCF — Beast in 3 weeks

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Strength - Peak 87% - Squat 5x3 @87% - Bench 5x3 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x3 - Rope Climb 4x3 <i>Run PM: VO2max 4x1 mile @RPE 9</i>	Swim + Peak OCF - 25min swim - Max grip sequence 5x - Sandbag carry 5x50m (45lb M/35lb W — RACE WEIGHT) - Bucket carry 4x50m	Strength Peak 87% - RDL 5x3 @87% - OHP 5x3 - Atlas Stone sim 5x3 - Sled Push max 4x30m <i>Trail bike 45min + trail run 25min</i>	Swim + Beast Sim - 20min swim - Full Beast circuit 30min - Score + time it - Compare vs Wk 29 score <i>SPIN CLASS PM: 45 min @5:30 PM — Zone 3-4 intervals</i>	Strength Peak 87% - Squat 5x3 - Bench 5x3 - Wtd Pull-Up 5x3 - Farmers Carry 5x50m (max) <i>Rest PM</i>	LONGEST BEAST SESSION - 2-hr trail run with obstacles - Full kit + race nutrition - Simulate Beast effort - Trust your fitness	Mandatory Rest - NO training - Sleep 9hrs - Ice bath - Visualize Beast 21k finish

WK 32 Oct 26 - Nov 1 — TAPER — Spartan Beast Nov 7

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Taper Strength 70% - Squat 3x5 @70% - Bench 3x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 30min only <i>Easy run 20min Zone 2</i>	Swim - Easy - 20min easy swim - Light OCF: 2x rope hang 20s - Stay loose	Light Strength 68% - All lifts 3x5 @68% - 25min - No grinding <i>Easy bike 25min opener</i>	Swim + Light OCF - 15min swim - Sandbag carry 2x30m (25lb — taper) - Grip hang 2x20s <i>SKIP SPIN — Spartan Beast taper week</i>	REST - Full rest - Carb-load dinner - Gear for BOTH races ready - Sleep 9hrs	Easy Openers - 20min easy trail run - 4 strides @race pace - Short rope hang 2x20s - REST	Final Rest Before Beast - Full rest - Visualize Beast 21k - Trust the work - Sleep 9+ hrs

WK 33 Nov 2-8 — RACE WEEKEND — Beast Nov 7 + Sprint Nov 8 RACE: Beast+Sprint - Nov 7-8

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Light Strength 60% - Squat 2x5 @60% - Bench 2x5 - Pull-Up 3x5 - 15min only <i>Easy run 15min</i>	Swim - Easy - 15min easy swim - Stay fresh - No OCF drills	Very Light 55% - 2x5 @55% all lifts - 10min max <i>Easy bike 15min</i>	Short Swim + Walk - 15min easy swim - 20min easy walk - Rest is training <i>SKIP SPIN — Beast + Sprint race weekend</i>	REST - FULL REST - Carb-load dinner - BOTH race kits ready - Sleep 9+ hrs	SPARTAN BEAST - RACE - RACE DAY - Beast 21k! - Pace the first 10km easy - Gel every 4km - Save legs for Sprint tomorrow!	SPARTAN SPRINT - RACE - RACE DAY - Sprint 5km! - Legs are tired - push anyway - It's the LAST RACE of the season - FINISH STRONG - YOU DID IT!

QUICK REFERENCE - HYBRID ATHLETE CHEAT SHEET

SITUATION	ACTION	MINIMUM EFFECTIVE DOSE
Short on time (30 min)	Do main lifts only: squat + press + pull	3 compound lifts x 3 sets = done
Traveling, no gym	Hotel circuit (see travel page) + outdoor run	20-min bodyweight circuit counts
Legs dead after long effort	Active recovery Sunday + extra protein	Walk + eat. No training.
Missed a session	Move on. Do not double up next day.	Consistency > perfection
Race week	Cut volume 40%, keep 2 quality sessions	Short run + swim + light lift
Feeling overtrained	Take 2 full rest days. Eat more.	Sleep + food = best recovery tool
Pre-race nerves	Trust the training. Stick to race nutrition.	Nothing new on race day
Poor sleep night before race	Normal. Won't affect performance.	Focus on 2 nights before race
Mon run hard after lifting	Normal adaptation - it will improve.	Zone 2 only - don't push RPE
Tue/Thu swim with tired arms	Reduce intensity, keep volume.	Technique > pace when fatigued
Thu spin on heavy OCF weeks	Go to spin — it's low-impact vs running	Spin builds bike leg, won't hurt OCF

"DO THE WORK. TRUST THE PROCESS. BECOME UNCOMMON AMONGST UNCOMMON PEOPLE."

- Nick Bare, Hybrid Athlete